

1. The Multi-Source Corpus Approach

Building a masculinity corpus isn't just about making a list of words—it's about creating a framework that captures how masculine norms are expressed across different contexts. Research shows masculinity content on social media has distinct categories that your corpus should reflect.

The Masculinity Content Classification Framework (MCCF)

A recent 2026 study developed the first operationalized coding framework for mainstream manosphere content on TikTok, which is directly applicable to your prototype.

Category	Description	Example Content
Cultural Touchpoints	Innocuous entry point content (not manosphere itself)	Sports, gaming, fitness, general lifestyle
Procuring Masculine Status	Content about achieving or performing masculinity	Dating advice, financial success, physical appearance enhancement, "alpha" status
Degrading Social/Emotional Wellbeing	Harmful manosphere content	Misogyny, violence, gender essentialism, male victimhood narratives

Key finding: In a study of 2,414 TikTok videos from 142 young men (aged 16-25), cultural touchpoint content appeared in 37.74% of videos, while the latter two categories appeared in 5.76%. This means your corpus should weight different categories

appropriately—most content isn't explicitly "toxic," but it can still serve as an entry point to manosphere themes.

2. Where to Get Corpus Content

Option A: Existing Academic Corpora

The search results indicate several established research corpora you can draw from:

Corpus Source	Description	Relevance
Andrew Tate's written discourses	16,029 words across 64 webpages + 150,288 words across 2,191 Telegram posts	Contains unfiltered manosphere content; ideal for dictionary building
Twitter/X alpha male discourse	~700 tweets across 6 years (2010-2024) from the Corpus of Contemporary American English (COCA)	Tracks semantic evolution; shows polarized discourse
MasculinitySaturday hashtag data	Public X data analyzing masculine norms and ideologies	Captures contemporary masculine discourse patterns
Ekşi Sözlük entries	1,038 entries on masculinity topics using Critical Discursive Psychology approach	Reveals interpretative repertoires (how masculinity is linguistically constructed)

Option B: Build Your Own with Official APIs

Based on the meeting, you've already decided to use YouTube Data API v3. This is the safest approach. You can:

1. Target specific masculinity-focused channels (e.g., fitness influencers, dating coaches, self-improvement channels)
 2. Download comments and video descriptions using the API
 3. Annotate them using the MCCF categories
 4. Expand iteratively as you analyze more content
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3. The Dictionary-Based Approach

You mentioned in the meeting that you were leaning toward a dictionary/keyword approach rather than full semantic analysis. This is a practical first step, and the search results provide excellent word lists to start with.

Masculine-Coded Word List (from the Gender Decoder Tool)

A 2011 research paper by Gaucher, Friesen, and Kay identified these masculine-coded words that are still used in contemporary research:

Category	Example Words
Dominance/Authority	Dominant, aggressive, forceful, assertive, superior
Competition	Competitive, champion, challenge, battle, fearless
Independence	Independent, self-reliant, autonomous, individual

Analysis/Logic	Analytical, objective, logical, decisive, intellect
Confidence	Confident, outspoken, persistent, determined, ambitious

Important note: The research found that women felt job adverts with masculine-coded language were less appealing and that they "belonged" less in those occupations. This demonstrates that word-level analysis alone can reveal meaningful patterns in how masculinity is linguistically constructed.

Gendered Discourse Words (from the GDCF Framework)

A 2025 study on podcast discourse identified that men use more:

Discourse Type	Description
Filled pauses	"uh," "um"
Repeats	Repetition of words or phrases
Discourse markers	"well," "you know," "I mean"
False starts	"It was... anyway..."

These discourse patterns are masculine defaults—men are socially rewarded for these speech patterns, and they correlate with higher status in domains like business, technology, and politics.

4. The Interpretative Repertoires Approach

A study analyzing 1,038 Turkish dictionary entries on masculinity identified six interpretative repertoires (linguistic resources people use to construct masculine identity):

Repertoire	Description	Keywords/Concepts to Include
"Essence" and "other"	Natural, biologically-given male differences	Biology, nature, born, genes, instinct
Preoccupation with sexuality	Sexuality central to male identity	Sexual performance, partners, conquest
Responsibilities and obligations	What society expects of men	Provider, protector, duty, obligation, honor
Patriarchal system and mother's son	How patriarchy shapes male behavior	Tradition, family honor, mother's role, upbringing
Masculine performance	Activities proving manhood	Cars, football, repairs, gym, sports
Femininity vs. masculinity	Defined through contrast with women	Not feminine, not weak, not emotional

5. Implementation Strategy for Your Prototype

Phase 1: Seed Dictionary

Start with a curated word list based on existing research:

python

```
masculinity_corpus = {
    "dominance_authority": ["dominant", "alpha", "leader", "boss", "command",
"control"],
    "competition": ["win", "champion", "battle", "challenge", "grind",
"hustle"],
    "independence": ["independent", "self-reliant", "alone", "own",
"autonomous"],
    "stoicism": ["tough", "strong", "hard", "no emotion", "man up", "don't
cry"],
    "aggression": ["fight", "warrior", "aggressive", "force", "destroy"],
    "provider_protector": ["protect", "provide", "secure", "safe", "guardian",
"breadwinner"],
    "physical_appearance": ["gym", "muscle", "fit", "ripped", "alpha
physique"],
    "status_material": ["rich", "success", "money", "power", "influence"],
    # Add based on MCCF categories
    "cultural_touchpoints": ["sports", "gaming", "fitness", "gym", "cars"],
    "toxic_markers": ["misogyny", "feminist destroyed", "men's rights",
"victimhood"]
}
```

Phase 2: Expand with Co-occurrence Analysis

Use the Gendered Discourse Correlation Framework (GDCF) approach:

1. Collect YouTube comments on masculinity-related videos
2. Identify words that co-occur with masculinity terms
3. Calculate correlations between words and masculine/feminine discourse
4. Build word lists automatically

Phase 3: Refine with Machine Learning

Use topic modeling (LDA or BERTopic) to discover emerging terms and categories from your collected data.

6. Validation and Refinement

Subject Expert Validation

The corpus should be validated by:

Expert Type	Role
Gender studies/masculinity researcher	Ensure theoretical accuracy
NLP practitioner	Ensure corpus is technically sound
Your industry expert friend	Ensure practical applicability

Iterative Refinement

The search results show that corpora in this domain are never one-shot creations. For example, the MCCF study involved:

1. Social media monitoring (Phase 1 - inductive development)
2. Application to real-world data (Phase 2 - refinement based on actual content)

You should follow a similar approach:

1. Build seed corpus from existing research
2. Test on YouTube comments
3. Refine based on what you find
4. Repeat